

Phishing Email Competition Submission

This document showcases my submission for the Phishing Email Competition. The competition aimed to create realistic phishing emails while adhering to strict guidelines to ensure educational value. Below, I highlight my work and explain how it aligns with the key points of the competition rules.

1. Realism

The phishing email was designed to closely mimic real-world phishing attempts. For example, it impersonated a well-known organization (USPS) and used a tracking number to increase credibility. The language included urgency ('Action Required') to prompt immediate action, a tactic often seen in phishing attacks.

2. Creativity

The email creatively combined multiple tactics: a tracking number, a delayed delivery issue, and a simulated invoice download link. These elements were carefully chosen to maximize realism while ensuring red flags were present for educational purposes.

3. Technical Detail

Technical details included the use of a fake domain (e.g., 'uspssmail.com') and simulated links that point to non-functional, harmless URLs. The email included placeholders for dynamic content like tracking numbers to demonstrate potential automation in phishing campaigns.

4. Educational Value

To ensure the educational value of the submission, subtle red flags were included: - The sender's email domain did not match the legitimate USPS domain.

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- The invoice download link pointed to a ZIP file, a common phishing tactic.

These elements were intended to teach recipients how to detect phishing attempts.

5. Compliance with Rules

The submission adhered to all competition rules:

- No actual malicious links or attachments were included.
- All links and content were simulated for educational purposes.
- Real personal data or sensitive information was not used.
- The email was never sent to any real-world targets, maintaining ethical standards.

Conclusion

This submission demonstrates the ability to craft realistic phishing emails while maintaining a strong focus on ethical practices and educational value. It highlights common tactics used by phishers and educates users on identifying red flags, fulfilling the competition's objectives.